LESSON 4

Ode to Joy

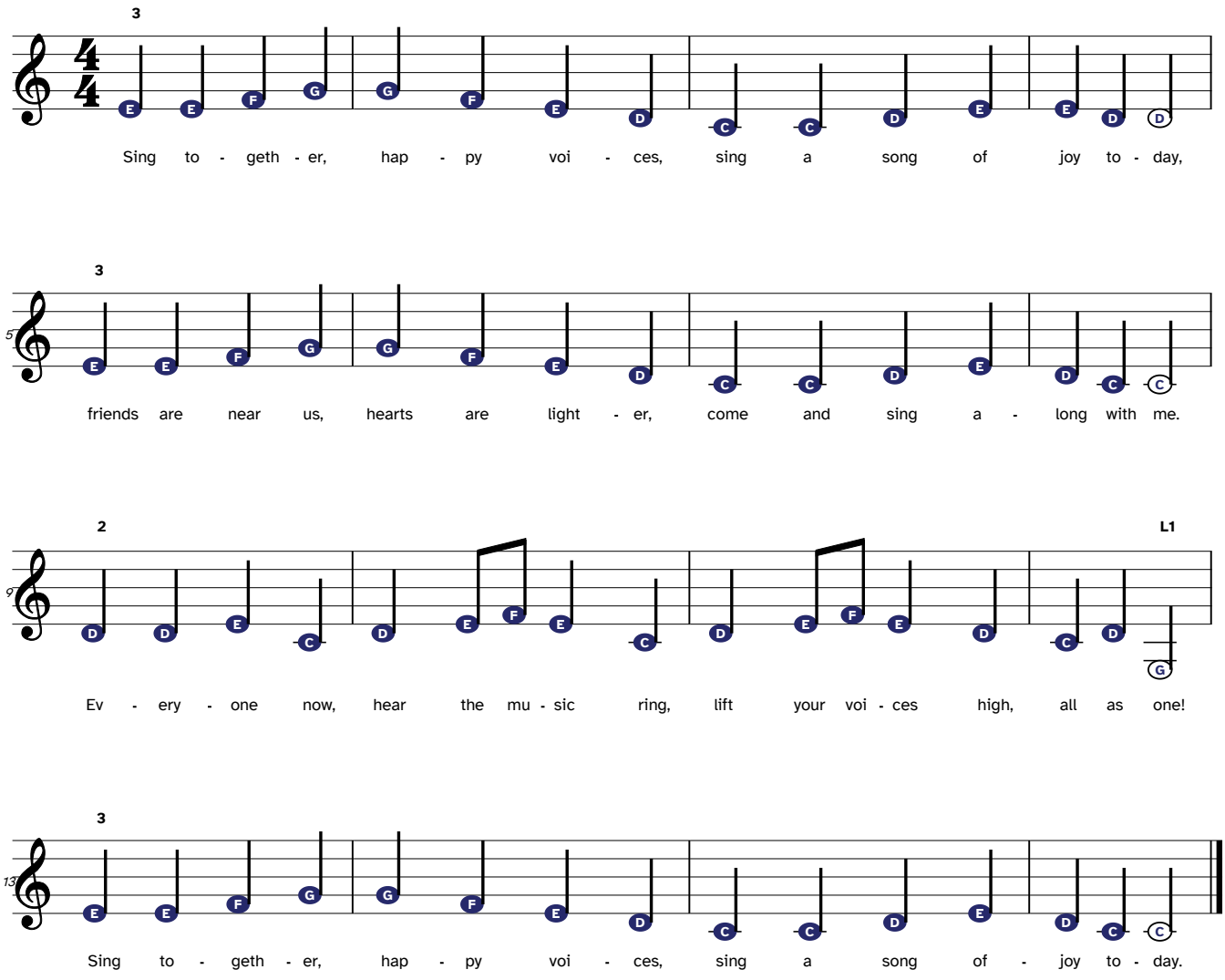
Beethoven's Ninth Symphony, first played in Vienna in 1824. The words here are our own.

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

THE WOW MOMENT
☆ **Beethoven never heard it:** he was deaf by the first concert. Play it loud and proud, for him.

1 Meet the song

Five lines and the Queen's sign, whose curl wraps round line 2: G. Listen, point, then sing.



☐ Listened and pointed ☐ Sang it with the words ☐ Sang the letter names

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES



crotchet: walk
1 beat

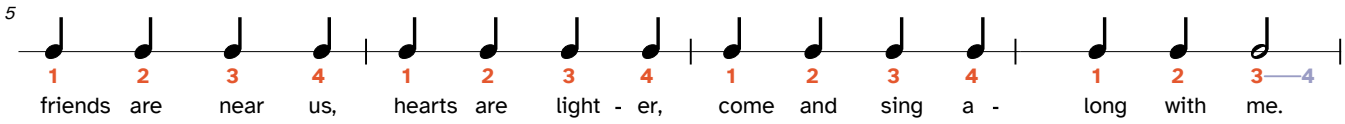


two quavers: run-ning
1 beat



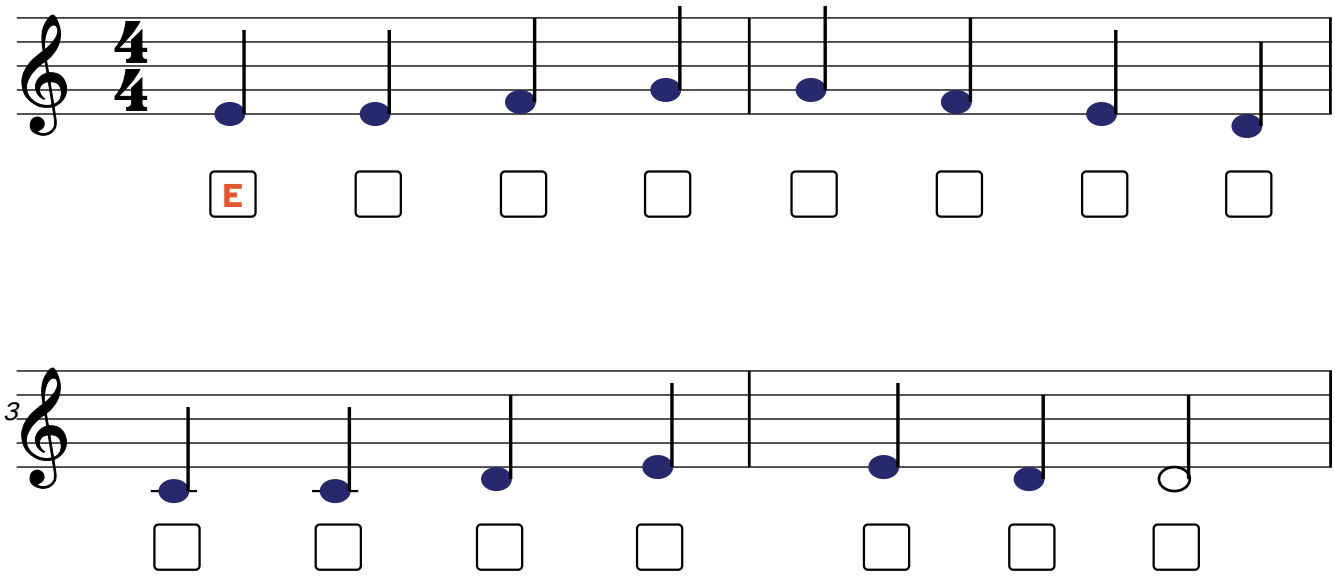
minim: hold
2 beats





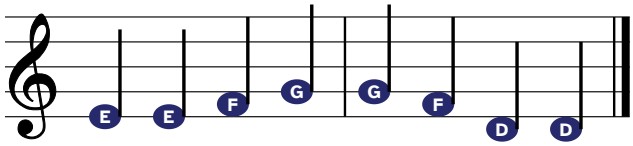
THE NOTES

Write the letter name under each note of the first four bars. E sits on the bottom line, G on line 2.



SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

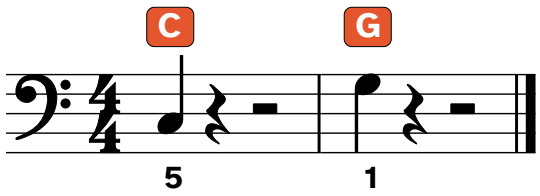
3 Lead sheet

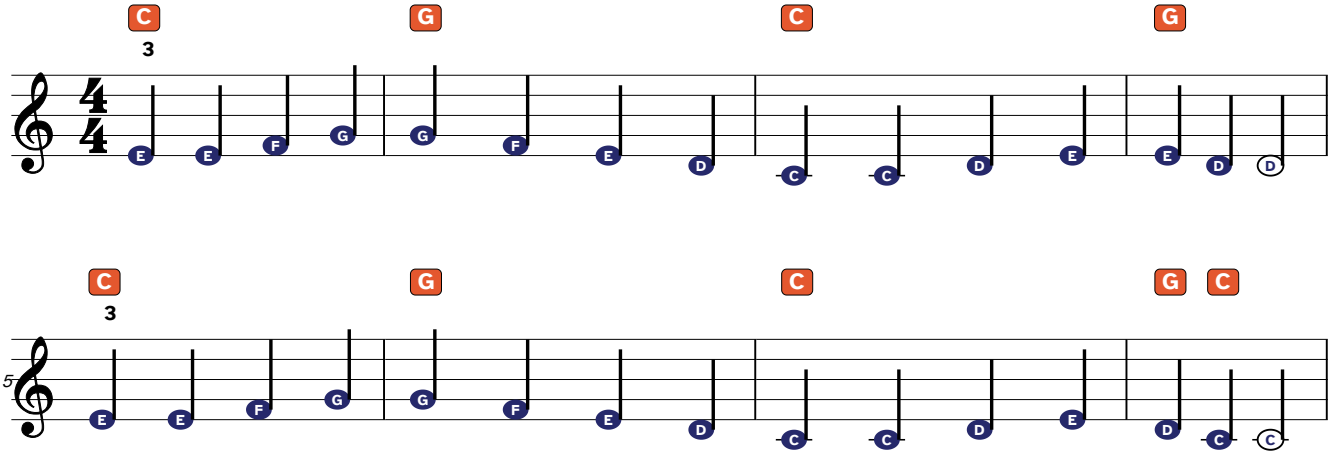
The tune and its chord names. Now the left hand joins in: it taps each name's root, once, on beat 1.

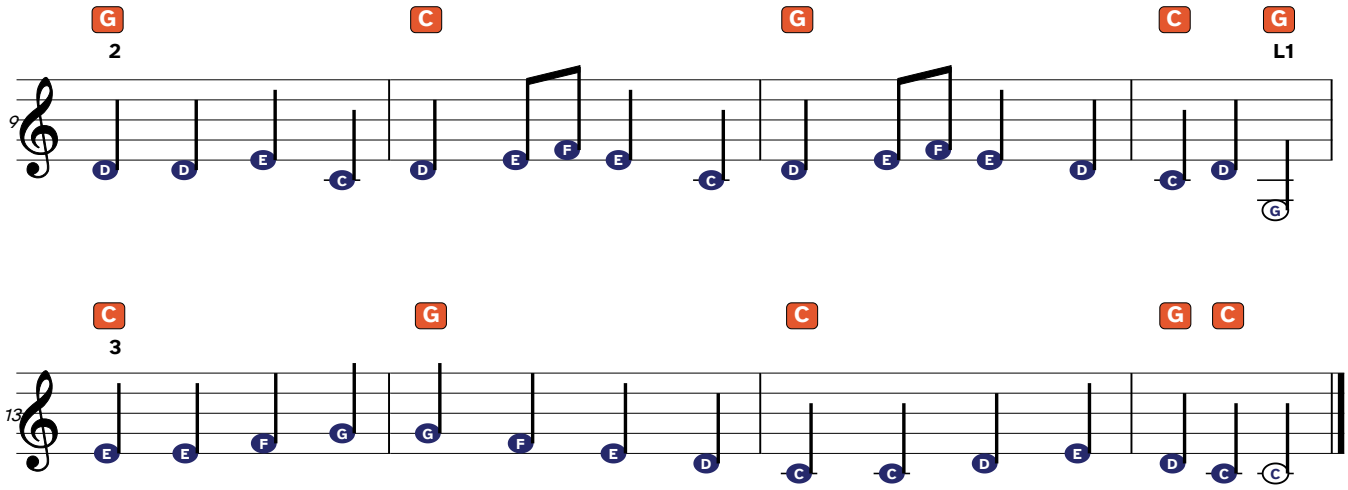
TAP THE ROOT

The root is the chord's own letter: C for C, G for G. Play it once, on beat 1, and let it ring.

C G







1 Tune alone, right hand

2 Left hand alone: tap the roots while the recording plays the tune

3 Together, slowly

4 · CHECK

☐ I can say and clap it ☐ I can sing it with the words

☐ I can find E and G on the staff

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	With letters	No letters	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the roots				

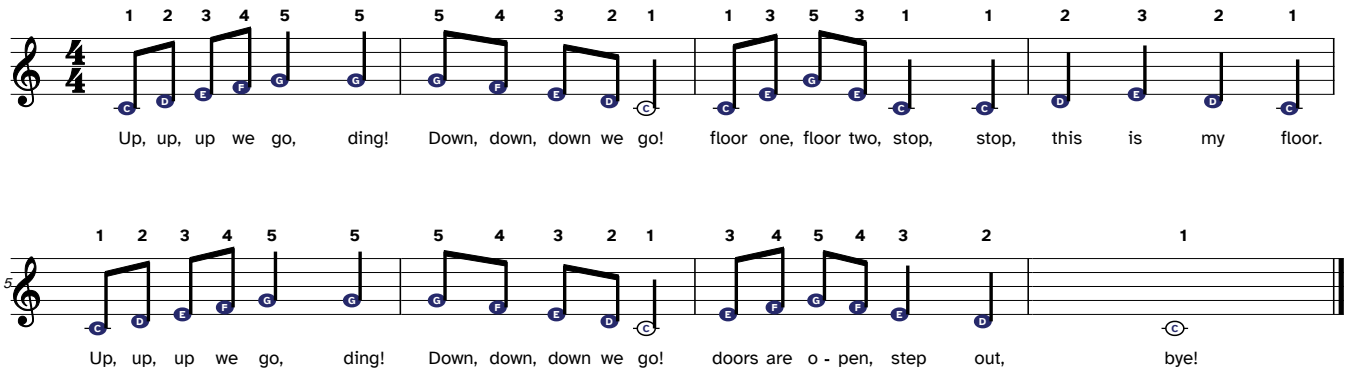
LISTEN BACK ☐ I recorded it ☐ It sounded right

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

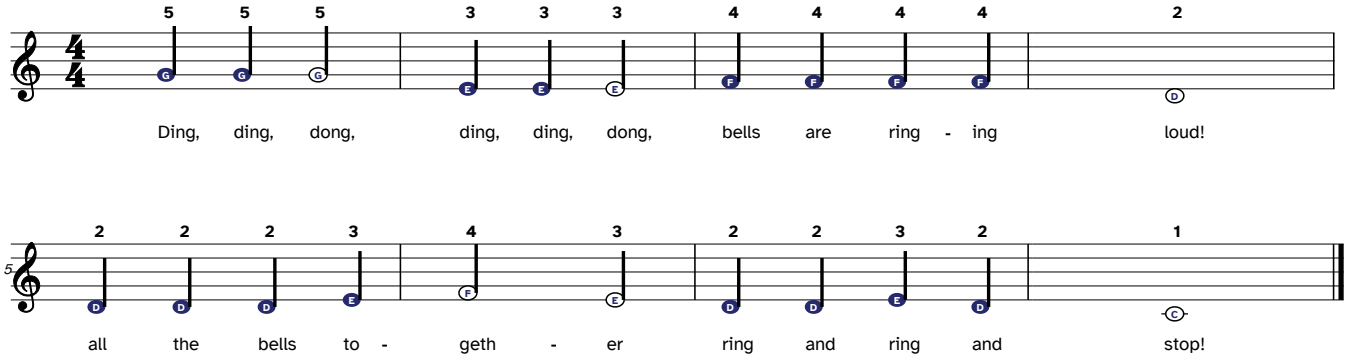
THE LIFT

A lift ride, quick and cheerful: all five fingers run up to G and back down, then hop between floors.



RING THE BELLS

Bright and ringing, a peek at Lesson 5: the same note again and again, then long notes to hold.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- [ ] **Loud and proud, like a whole orchestra**
- [ ] **New house: thumb on G, the same fingers, the same song**
- [ ] **Soft and slow, like a prayer**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. Right hand, the whole song
3. Left hand: tap the roots (page 3)
4. Play it with the orchestra

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

- [ ] **Played The Lift**
- [ ] **Played Ring the Bells**